

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Heritage diplomacy is an application anchor, never doctrinal proof.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Buddhist pramāṇa theory, apoha, avyākṛta questions and controlled cross-school objections are CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH where they sharpen PYQ answers.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Pratītyasamutpāda, kṣaṇikavāda, nairātmyavāda, nirvāṇa and the four-school contrast are CORE SYLLABUS.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Heritage diplomacy is an application anchor, never doctrinal proof.

ANSWER LINE: Pratītyasamutpāda, kṣaṇikavāda, nairātmyavāda, nirvāṇa and the four-school contrast are CORE SYLLABUS.

02

Contemporary-anchor discipline

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Fact: The High Commission of India in Colombo reported the public exposition of the Devnimori Buddha relics at Gangaramaya Temple from 4–10 February 2026, presenting it as cultural and spiritual engagement through shared Buddhist heritage.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Inference: The event can frame Buddhism as a living civilizational language, but answers must derive doctrine from dependent origination, momentariness, no-self, emptiness, consciousness and liberation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ Fact: The High Commission of India in Colombo reported the public exposition of the Devnimori Buddha relics at Gangaramaya Temple from 4–10 February 2026, presenting it as cultural and spiritual engagement through shared Buddhist heritage.

ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: The High Commission of India in Colombo reported the public exposition of the Devnimori Buddha relics at Gangaramaya Temple from 4–10 February 2026, presenting it as cultural and spiritual engagement through shared Buddhist heritage.

03

Master distinction gateway

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Master verdict: Buddhism is a family of anti-substantialist, causally ordered and soteriological systems; its schools range from realism through consciousness-only analysis to radical emptiness.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Master verdict: Buddhism is a family of anti-substantialist, causally ordered and soteriological systems; its schools range from realism through consciousness-only analysis to radical emptiness.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

It is the key to the arising of duḥkha and therefore the key to its cessation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Exam key: In Buddhism, the three syllabus terms are not separate islands.

ANSWER LINE: Recommended opening definition: pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination) is the principle that phenomena arise and cease in dependence on conditions, rejecting both eternalism and causeless annihilationism.